about Hamas. Alternatively, one can see whether they discuss the Palestinian-Israeli conflict but remain silent about the genocidal agenda of this movement.[28]

One example will have to suffice: an article co-authored by the former U.S. President Jimmy Carter and Mary Robinson, the former Irish President and UN High Commissioner for Human Rights. During the Protective Edge campaign of 2014, the two published an article asking the world to recognize Hamas. The article criticized Israel for many issues, such as Israel's refusal to recognize the Palestinian government supported by both the Palestinian Authority and Hamas, and a variety of other issues.[29] However, they remained silent about the Hamas Charter, which speaks about the killing of all Jews. They also did not mention the many remarks stating all Jews should be killed that were made by Hamas' political and military leaders during the Protective Edge campaign.

CONCLUSION

Using the Jewish experience as a prism has many applications, as Israel and the Jews often appear in the media and in the Western public debate. Historically, European nations and their leaders treated Jews in many different ways. Jews interacted with these societies on different levels over many centuries. Since the Second World War, the remaining European Jews represent a fragment of one percent of the population, yet issues concerning the Jewish community regularly make headlines. At the end of the 20th century, that was the case, for instance, with the return of the Holocaust restitution issue. In 2015, headlines are being made yet again with a renewed outburst of antisemitism, a phenomenon which is an intrinsic part of Europe's culture and history.

One should add to this list the European interaction with Israel, strongly influenced by the global obsession with the Palestinian-Israeli conflict. This fact explains in part why Israel receives so much media attention. The strong, often negative, European focus on the Jewish experience has enabled the creation of a prism that reveals what is highly problematic with large parts of European societies.

Prisms provide snapshots for events relevant to certain times, but can be applied later on to see how such matters have evolved. This is the case, for instance, concerning Scotland. Both the frequency of Scottish antisemitic events and the obsession of some of its elected representatives with Israeli institutions can serve as parameters. These can be combined with social, economic and other statistical indicators. The same is true of Britain and

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